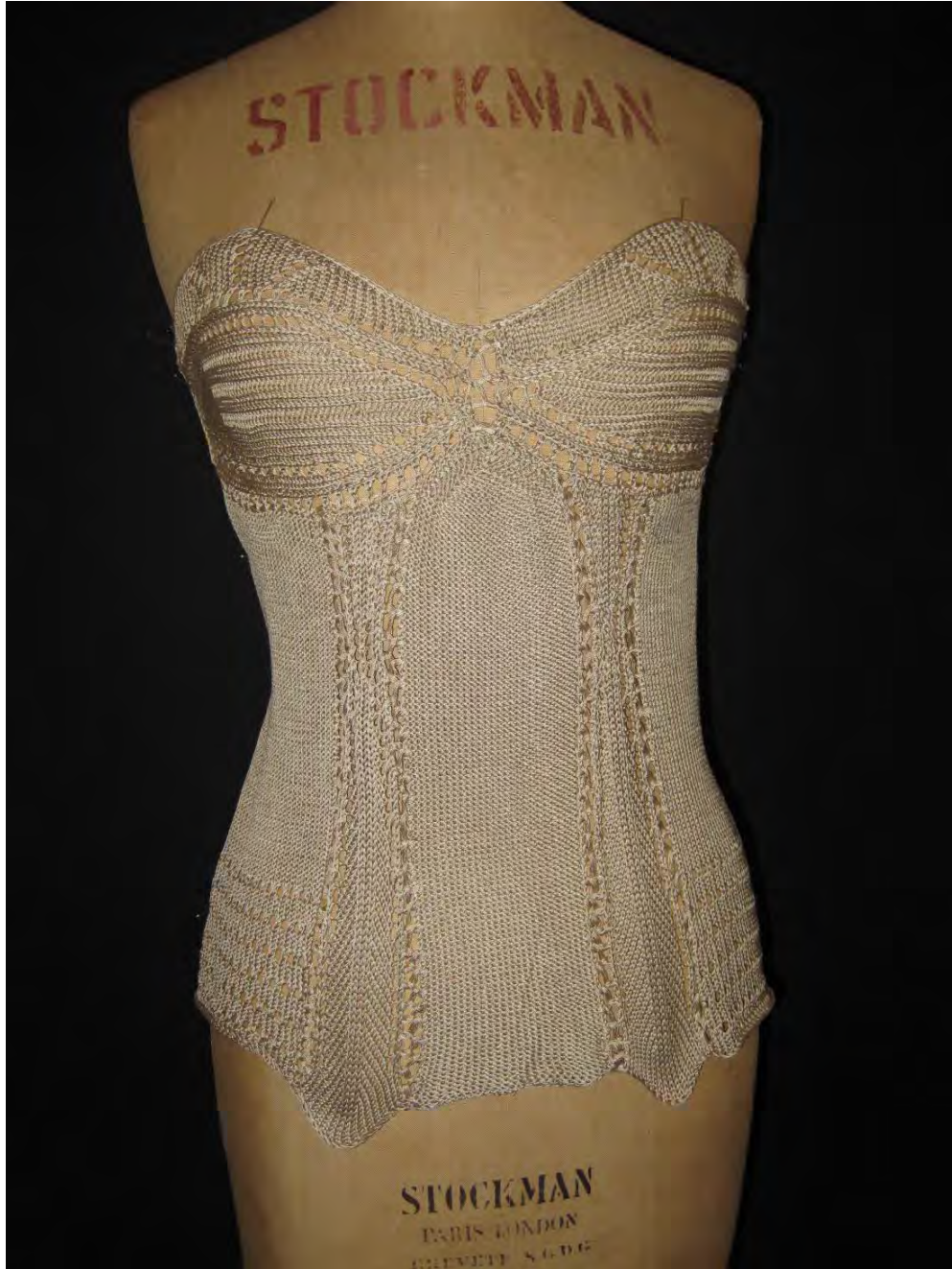


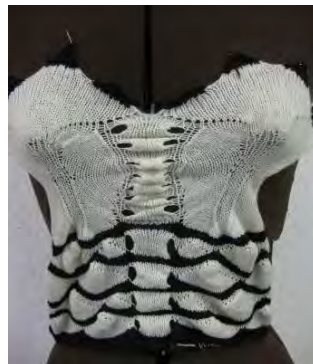
LEARN CURVES AND CONTOURS



**MACHINE KNIT
WITH KNIT-1**

Curves and Contours

Learn to create body conscious fashion.



Curves and Contours

This course includes:

- ❖ Godets
- ❖ Short row circular sections
- ❖ Fashion inspiration
- ❖ Decorative fashioning
- ❖ Pointelle and closed fashioning
- ❖ Sock heel technique
- ❖ Bust shaping
- ❖ Darts
- ❖ Short row darts
- ❖ Oval or Ellipse shape
- ❖ Shaped insets

All worked on standard gauge single bed machinery

Beginner to Intermediate level

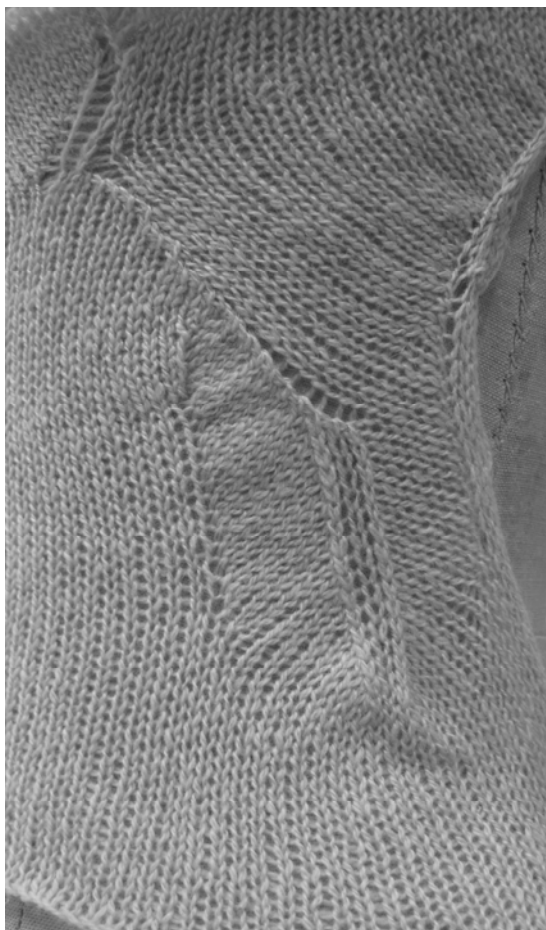
‘Contours fashioning – a most useful technique for fabric manipulation. Something I would not have grasped on my own’ Emma (UK)



Inspiration



We will be looking at how to knit curves and contours through fashioning stitches, using short rows and combining these techniques.



Fashioning is about subtle changes of direction of the knit within the knit reducing or creating extra dimension and shaping



Step by step we will knit with sock heel technique, fashion darts and integral bust shaping, as well as short row circles, godets, darts and bust shaping.

Godets.



(A)

A godet is a triangular insert used to inject flare into a flat fabric. You can use one or many godets, they start at any mid-point within the fabric and end at the edge which becomes waves or folds.



- Cast on and knit some rows.
- On your carriage switch to **H**
- *Pull 4 needles out to holding position.
- Knit 2 rows.
- Pull 2 more needles out so 6 in total.
- Knit 2 rows.



- Continue until all needles are in holding position.
- Then work in the opposite direction pushing 2 needles back to pos. **D**

These will now knit.

- Knit 2 rows
- Keep on pushing back the needles two at a time until 4 remain.
- Knit some rows over all needles by switching carriage back to **N**.



To replicate the piece in the picture **(A)**;

knit the first godet as above.

Knit 6 rows across all needles then repeat from * exactly 3 more times.



Place your godets on a dress form and see where you'd like to use them.



They make ruffles if you drape them,



Voluminous shapes if you gather the edges for a shoulder detail.



make a peplum at the waist.....

....or simply use it to shape the fabric around the body.

It is a way of building extra fabric turning corners and adding angles to your knitting.

A godet is simply a section of a circle.



If you select big groups of needles and knit few rows – e.g. 8 needles and 2 rows, your godets will be slender and make a trumpet shape angle.

If you select small groups of needles e.g. 1 or 2 and knit 4 rows you will make very wide voluminous godets and have a great amount of fabric at your edge.



Examples of short row shapes

Short row knitting

Partial knitting is a technique that can be used mainly for skirt darts, shaping necklines and shoulders, hemlines and sock heels.



On your carriage, you should have a switch like this, **N** for normal knitting **H** for holding position. (Brother machine)

On the left side of the needle bed you will see **A, B, D, E** marked. These are markings for needle positions and have different functions (see glossary)

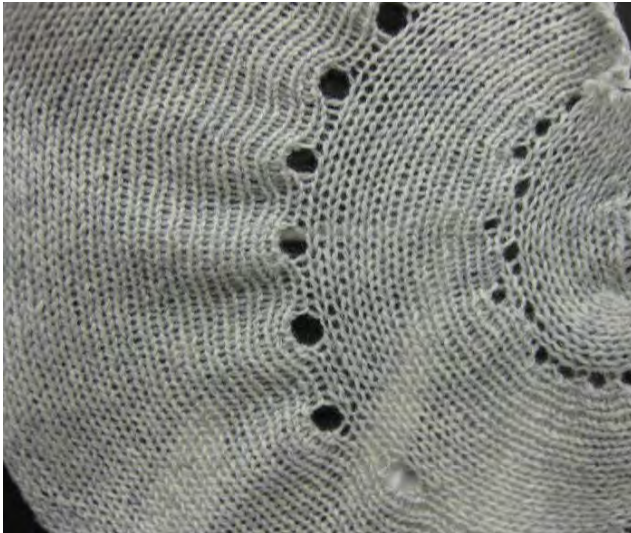
When knitting, plain knit, your needles will be in position **B or WP**

When the needles are pulled out as far as they can be towards you there are in position **E or HP**. They will not knit and are in **holding position**. Everything else will knit



This is the same piece gathered to make a great shoulder shape

Short row circle.



Short row circles are knitted Vertically with the rows 'pulling' at one side (the inner Edge of the circle)

This piece is being pieced together on a dress form using a short row circle placed over the shoulder to form bodice and sleeve integrally. The remaining bodice is made from a swatch with godets at both edges as explained previously.

You can create a short row circle using 3 'sections'.

Knit a different number of rows on each section, with the inner section having considerably less than the outer.

To knit this piece;

- Cast on 50 stitches.
- *Put 25sts into holding position, switch carriage to **H**
- Knit 6 rows on the remaining 25 needles knitting.





Push the
Needles back to
Position D

- Knit 4 rows over these, so 40 needles are knitting in total.



- Then push the last 10 needles back to D and knit 2 rows over all needles.
- Repeat from the beginning*.



Place on a dress form and see where you can use your circular shapes.

This example shows the same Technique but with more rows Between to make bigger holes



Fashioning Inspiration.

It is sometimes beneficial to have some historical reference to help your design process.

Vintage corsets and underwear structure could inspire your contour knitting. Corsets, by their nature, emphasise and exaggerate the curves and contours of the body. Use them for inspiration for stitch direction and where to put extra fabric/darts to fit the body.



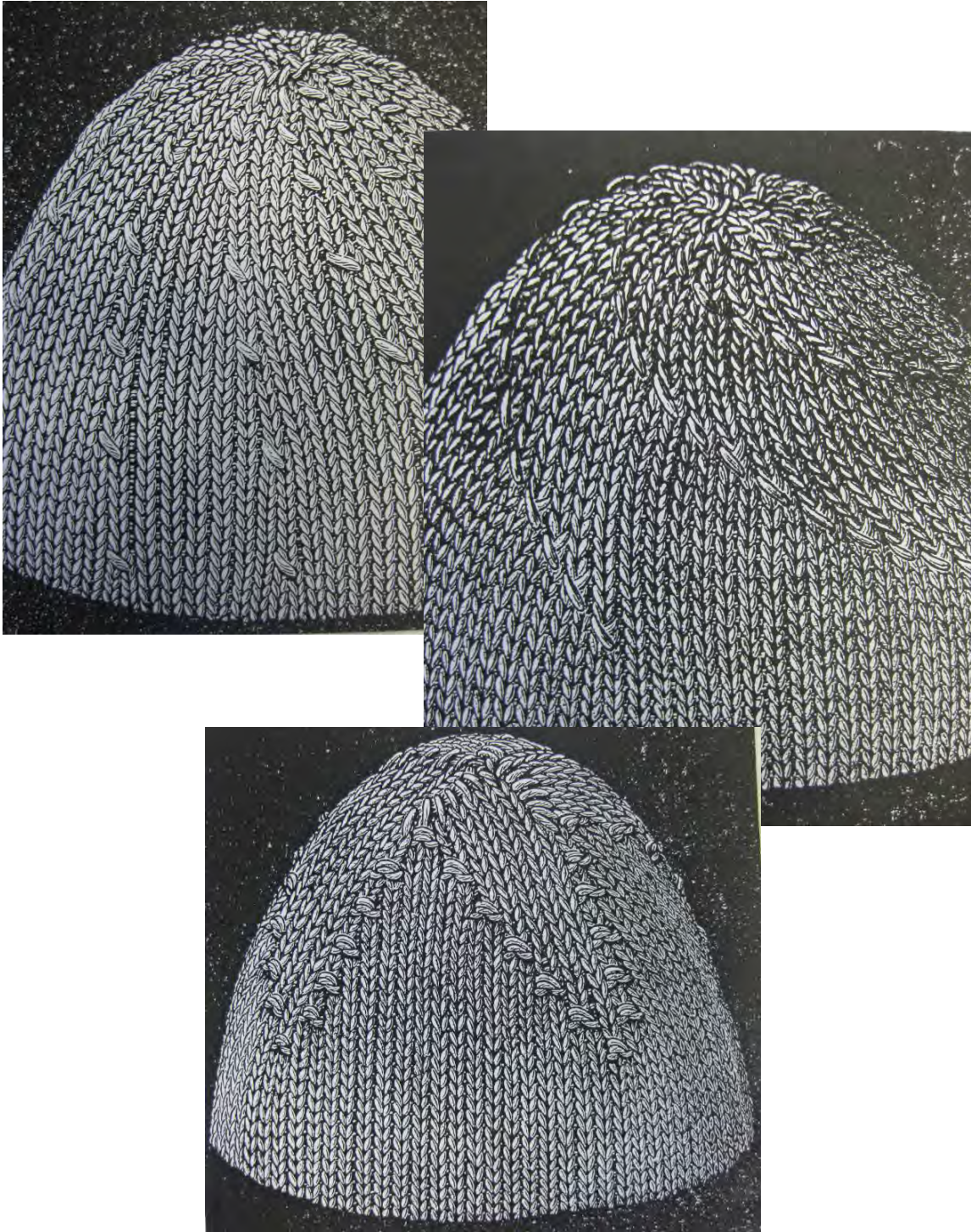
Vintage underwear and corsetry usually has interesting edges, silhouettes and unusual abdomen panel shapes.

Bras and bustiers give good bust shapes and details; think conical bras and lacing up.



This one is in the V&A Museum in London





So as short row knitting adds extra rows, fully fashioning can shape by reducing stitches at edges and create extra stitches within the fabric.

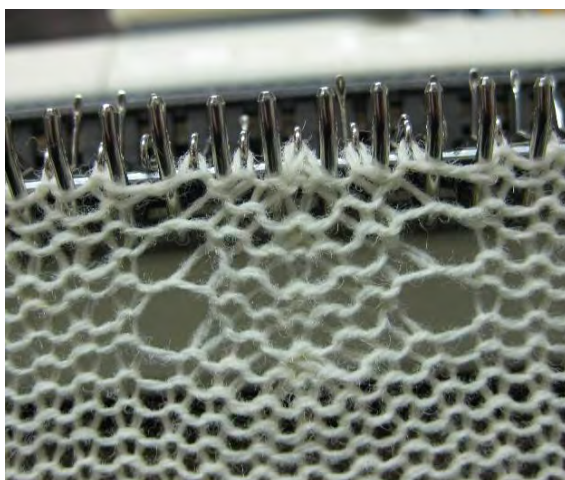
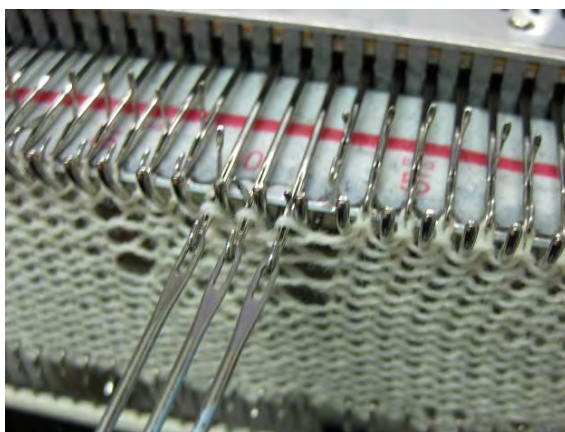
Use these techniques together to add and reduce fabric where necessary.

Decorative Fashioning.

This vintage stocking shows some classic fashioning marks. They make decorative stitch details.

To knit;

Take a group of 7 stitches. Think of the group as 3sts on the left 3sts on the right and one centre stitch.



On the right side see how the centre stitch protrudes forward as if it is a seam. Try a swatch with lots of these seams side by side.

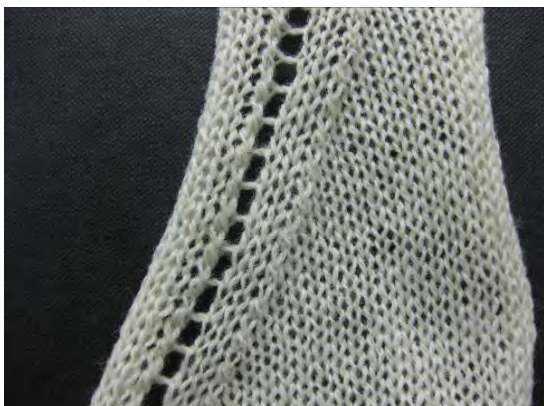
If we repeat the process but with 6 stitches moving into the centre each side you get something that looks like this.



- Take your three prong tool and move three stitches from needles onto the tool. Move them one stitch to the left.
- In the same way move 3 sts from the left one needle to the right.
- So the centre stitch holds a total of 3 sts.
- Knit 2 rows and repeat.



**More decorative ways of using eyelets with fully fashioning;
When decreasing stitches;**



Move the outer edge 3sts inwards by one stitch.

Fashion the next group of 3 sts. inwards by one stitch leaving an empty needle.

Knit 2 rows.



Or;

Fashion your six stitches one stitch inwards to decrease the edge.

Take the group of three stitches next to 6th stitch and fashion outwards, so back on itself.



- The sixth stitch now holds three stitches.



Combine the 'seam' from page 24 with fashioning an edge.

Do exactly as above but put in extra eyelet by moving the inner group of three sts. (of your group of 6).

These fashioning techniques look their best when you have fashioned two pieces, say an armhole and a sleeve, and then seam together.

Closing up Stitch.



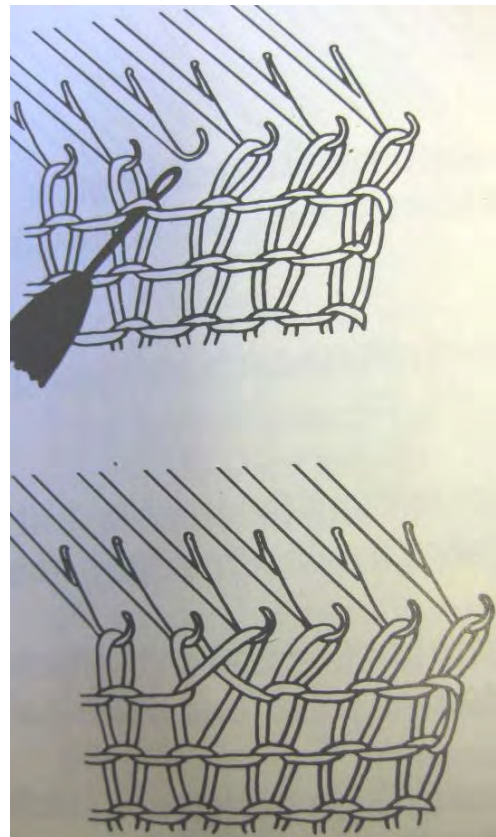
To make a swatch similar to the photo;

- Keep 6 stitches knitting straight in the centre of your swatch.
- Fashion everything else outwards to the edges where, at each edge, there is a group of 6 st. knitting straight.

To fashion stitches without getting an eyelet or pointelle hole you need a closing up stitch.

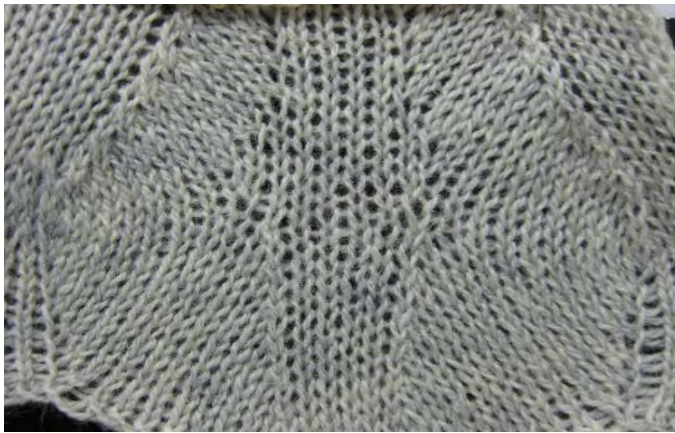
On the stitch next to the empty needle;

- Use the single end of your tool to find the stitch from the previous row knitted below it.
- Pick up this loop, often called the 'heel' of the stitch and put it onto the empty needle next to it.
- Knit 2 rows. Repeat.



Try a swatch with more groups of straight stitches.

Change direction and include lots of fashioning and movement.



This swatch has been made with a 'channel' of 4 stitches knitting straight in the centre.

16 stitches either side of it being transferred in towards it on **every** row.

Then after around 14 rows of this you simply change direction and transfer 16 stitches outwards **away** from the centre straight stitches.

Note how fashioning affects your swatch shape, i.e. if you fashion a large number of stitches at the edge, your edge will form points or scallops.

This swatch has 16 stitches being fashioned into the centre 2 stitches every 2 rows.

Note the difference between fashioning every 2 rows and fashioning every row.

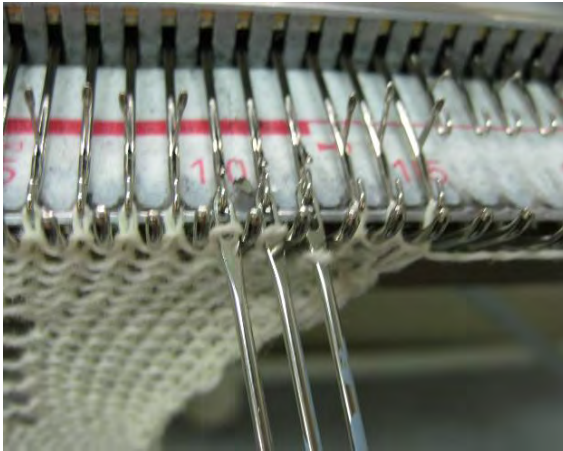




This shows all stitches closed up on rib fabric

Fashioning Edges

Fully fashioning can be used to shape a garment, to form contours for decreasing and increasing stitches at edges- armholes, necklines e.t.c.



To decrease one stitch;

Using the three prong tool, move the last six stitches (in two groups of three starting with the inside group) one stitch inwards.

Push the empty needle back out of action.

Knit 4 rows and repeat.

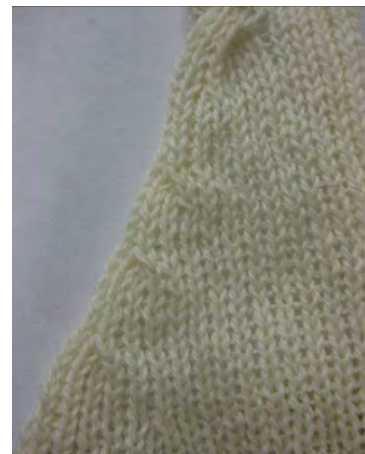


To **increase** the number of stitches by fully fashioning;

Use exactly the same procedure but move stitches outwards.

You will create an eyelet hole, where the stitches have moved along one needle. You can use this as a decorative mark or close it up.

This fashioning mark looks like half a cable. Move last three stitches inwards by two stitches to decrease stitches and achieve this look.







Sock Heel.



This is a way of forming a sock heel, though it can be cleverly used for other parts/ contours of the body.

It is essentially a diamond shape.

To make this shape;

- Transfer 12 stitches to the right.
- Leaving one stitch in the centre.
- Move 12 stitches to the left.
- Use the closing up stitch on each side.
- Knit 1 row.



- On the next row you need to leave 3 centre stitches knitting straight.
- Move 12 stitches to the left and the right
- In the centre you should have 1 empty needle 3 stitches 1 empty needle.
- Use the closing up

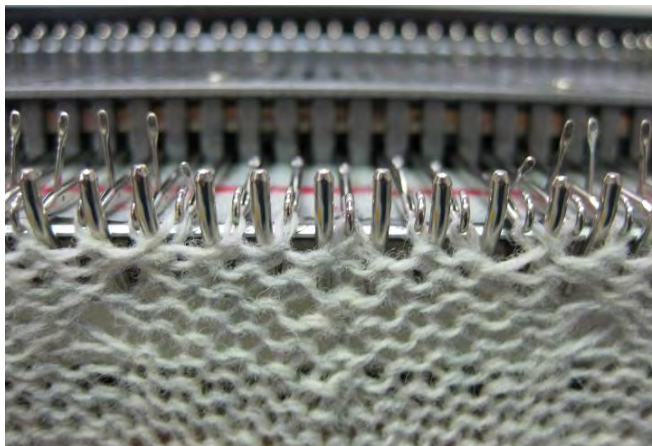
stitch to fill the empty needles.

- Knit 1 row.
- Repeat increasing the number of stitches in the centre (each row) until you have around 17 sts. knitting straight.



- Knit 6 rows.
- Fashion your 16 stitches back into the centre, with the centre stitch having 3 sts.
- Knit 2 rows.

- Remember to close up the eyelet holes left by fashioning back inwards.
- When all stitches have been fashioned back in you have finished your 'heel'.





So make your 'heel' as big or as small you like.



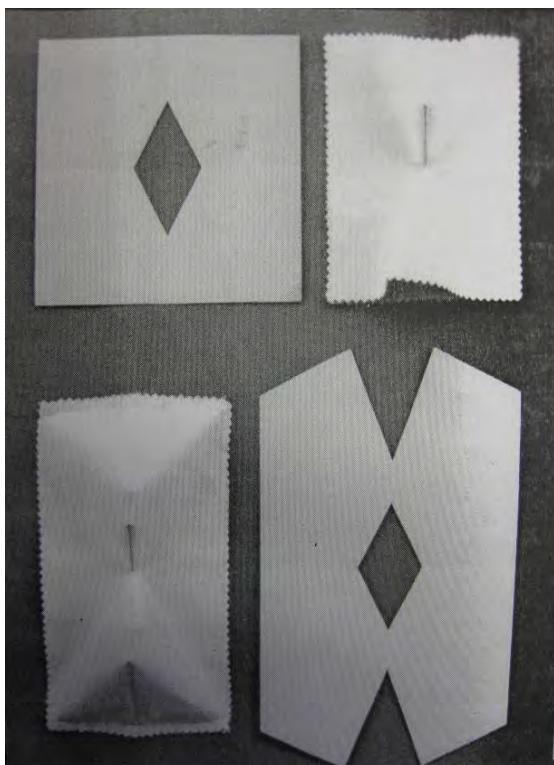
Apply the same technique to shaping fabric on different parts of your garment.







Darts



Darts sculpt the fabric's surface into highs and lows.

These are examples of darts before and after construction in woven fabric squares.

You have already tried knit techniques that sculpt your knitting fabric.

Use them to replicate darts and apply them to get shape into your design.



This piece was knitted (with fully fashioned edges) exactly as the woven piece (above left) was cut.

The photo on the left shows the same sample with the seams sewn together.





This shows the detail of the seam.

The photo underneath shows exactly the same shape but knitted using fashioning and **no seam**.



This photo shows the detail of the seamless option.



For your swatch;

Leave a channel of stitches that won't be fashioned in the centre of your swatch, here there are 6.

Fashion all other stitches out towards the edges of the swatch.

Thereby increasing 1 stitch either side of the channel **every row**.

Use the closing up stitch to fill empty needles.

Repeat x 20

Knit 20 rows, no transferring stitches.

Now fashion all stitches back into the channel from the outer edges of the swatch, decreasing 1 stitch every row.

Use closing up stitch to fill empty needles at edges.

Knit 20 rows no fashioning and repeat from beginning to make two 'bust' shapes.



This photo show the seamless knit fitted on the form horizontally.



This photo shows the seamless knit on the form vertically

Short Row Darts.



Use the same technique as for the godets on page 6.

Instead of pulling needles gradually out into holding position until **all** are in hp, stop when you have 16 needles in hp.

Knit across all needles x 4 rows.

Repeat this and you will get a darted effect as the sample in the photo.

It is subtler than and doesn't produce as much extra fabric as the godets.

Short row 'darts' used here to make a semi circle piece of knit and shape around the waist and hip.





Oval/Ellipse shape



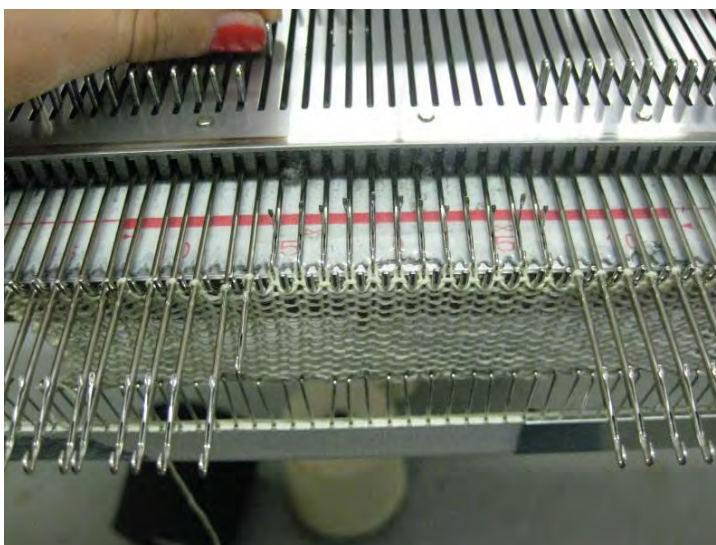
Useful for bust shaping, in this instance;

Here I have used a rib fabric so I can use the plain and purl stitches to follow the contours of the body.

I've knitted the bust shape using the holding cam and also by taking the whole bodice off the machine and hooking all stitches back on the reverse side so I have purl stitch and knit stitch on the right side of my swatch.

To make a basic ellipse shape;

- Use the holding cam as follows;
- Cast on 24 sts.
- Put carriage onto **H**.
- Pull out all needles into holding position, except 12* in the centre of your swatch.



(*Depending on how wide you need your ellipse shape).

Carriage is on left hand side.



Knit one row to the right.

- Push one needle on the left back to working position **D**.
- Knit one row to the left, and so on the right side push one needle back into working position **D**.

- Repeat this until all needles are in **WP**. You have made half the shape.
- Finish the shape by working back until all needles are in holding position bar the 12 centre needles.

So pull the needles back into position **E**, holding position, one needle by one row



In this picture you can see the extra fabric created in the middle of the Ellipse.



This photo shows a bodice with two bust shapes side by side. After making the ellipse shapes, continue knitting with a different colour, to emphasise the curve made by short row knitting





Shaped Insets

- To make the front cover bodice
- We started with the side dart insets first

- E wrap 19 stst
- Knit 10 r
- Transfer 6sts into the central 3sts both sides
- Repeat every 2 r for 20 r
- Dec both sides by 1 st then transfer 5sts into the central 3 sts every 2 r for 8r
- Dec both sides by 1 st
- Transfer 4 sts into central 3 sts ev 2 r for 8 r
- Dec 1sts both sides
transfer 3sts into central 3sts ev 2 r for 8r
- Dec both sides by 1 st
- Transfer 2 sts into central 3sts ev 2 r for 8 r
- Dec both sides by 1 st
- Transfer 1 sts into central 3 sts ev 2 r for 8r
- Now the shape starts to increase in width
- Inc 1st both sides
- Transfer 2sts into central 3sts ev 2 r for 8 r
- Inc 1 st both sides
- Transfer 3sts into central 3st ev 2 r for 4 r
- Cast off, make 2



- To make the central panel
- Ewrap 30sts
- Knit 110 r
- Dec 1st each side using a 3 prong tool
- Ev r for 8 r
- Continue dec to 1st and cast off
- Make 1



- To make side panel
- Ewrap 30sts
- Knit 6r
- Transfer ev other st to create pointelle
- Knit 6 r
- Repeat 5 more times to create a 'block' of 6 pointelle lines
- Knit 68r and cast off
- Make 2



- the next process is to stitch the panels together
- we use a simple 'fagot' stitch traditionally used on household linen



- this shows the stitching from the right side
- We have used the purl side of the central panel
- To create the fagot stitch you bring the needle behind the thread from the last stitch and then move from side to side diagonally

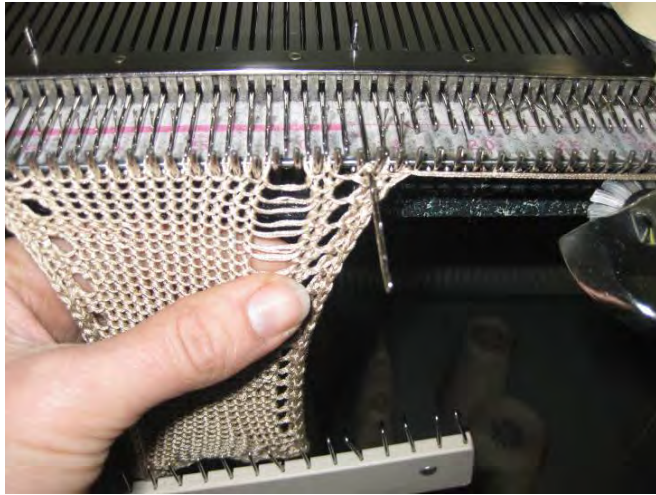


Deciding on the shape of the bust detail using paper patterns





- Knit 30 r pointelle ev 2 r



- To make the bust shape
- E wrap 3 sts
- Inc 1 st each side using 3 prong tool ev 2 r
- Stop inc when you have 25sts across

- To make the rib area systematically drop a pair of sts and pick up the floats with a latch tool



When you have picked up all the 'rib' stitches then continue knitting the piece

- Dec left side by 1 st ev 2 r
- On the right side dec 1 st ev 4 r
- Use a 3 prong tool
- Keep de until you have 12 sts then cast off
- Make one pair



- To make the top of the bust detail
- Hang the long edge onto 52 sts ev other needle
- Knit 1 r then bring all needles into action

- Knit 4 r working the central pointelle detail ev 2 r
- Hold 3sts and 1 st each side ev 2 r continuing pointelle pattern
- Continue holding and pointelle until 12 sts are left
- Cancel the holding cams
- Knit 1 loose row over all needles and cast off





- The final task is to join the lower bodice to the bust shape
- We did this by hanging the top of the lower bodice onto ev other needle
- (100 sts)
- Knit 1 r then bring all needles into action
- Knit 2 r
- Hang the bust shapes onto the same needles making sure they are exactly central
- Knit 1 very loose r then cast off



Glossary

E-wrap *cast on method for finished edge loop yarn around needles from left to right making the shape of a lower case e around each needle while needles are in E position.*

Sts *stitches(abbreviation)*

Prong tool *double ended tools that come with machine either have 1 and 2, 1 and 3, 2 and 3 prongs.*

Latch tool *tool that looks like a machine needle, used for picking up stitches.*

On the left side of the needle bed on machine

Needle position;

A *non working position/ needles will not knit*

B *working position / needles will knit*

D *selected for pattern knitting/ needles will knit*

E *holding position/ needles will knit unless holding cam is switched to H or II*

HP *holding position*

WP *working or knitting position.*

Holding cam *control on carriage on Brother machines N
Or H on Knitmaster I or II. Select H and II for short row
knitting, needles selected into position E will NOT knit.*

Swatch *piece of knitting/fabric*

Pointelle *lace knitting*

Eyelet *one stitch lace hole*

Fashion / fashioning *moving multiple stitches*

Cast off *bind off*

Dress Form *dummy/ mannequin*



The business was set up in 1992 by Richard Dykes and Sue Enticknap and worked to become established as one of the top fashion textile design companies, selling to the industry at all levels of the market.

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